PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
School District No. 1J, Multnomah County
Board of Education

October 13, 2026
Intergovernmental Affairs Committee Meeting

Informal Meeting Minutes

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Portland Public Schools Board of Education Intergovernmental Affairs Committee meeting was held virtually and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendees

Committee Members: Christy Splitt (Committee Chair); Patte Sullivan; Stephanie Englesman

Other attendees: Deborah Kafoury- Chief of Staff; Ben Gurewitz - Senior Manager, Government Relations; Kimberly Gibson - Portland Public Schools; Rosanne Powell - Senior Manager, Board Operations; Alicia Chavez - President, Portland Association of Teachers (PAT); Tina Lamanna - Vice President, PAT; Sarah Medeiros, Maya Pueo von Geldern, Suzanne Clark, Kyla Yeoman - Community and Parents for Public Schools (CPPS).

Call to Order / Introductions

Director Splitt called the meeting to order at 12:04 pm.

Public Comments

There were none.

Portland Association of Teachers (PAT) Legislative Priorities

PAT Vice President Tina Lamanna, presented the Oregon Education Association's (OEA) legislative priorities for the 2027 session, which PAT will support and explained that PAT does not set its own legislative priorities.

Committee members discussed areas of alignment with the District's legislative principles, including raising or removing the special education cap. Director Splitt suggested the Board consider whether to take a position on increasing revenue and whether to add language on AI, edtech, and screen time to its principles. Director Englesman emphasized that new mandates must come with funding and cautioned that the 15% special education cap proposed was lower than the rate PPS currently serves and should be set high enough to fund special education adequately. Director Sullivan asked that the Board guard against unfunded mandates.

Community and Parents for Public Schools (CPPS) Legislative Priorities

Representatives of CPPS presented their organization's views on legislative priorities, and agreed with the District's draft legislative principles. They urged the District to be more specific, including calling for raising or eliminating the special education cap, providing the public with data on how the system is serving English learners and students with disabilities, and publishing a list of unfunded mandates with their fiscal impact. CPPS also shared a video explaining how Oregon school funding works, and encouraged community members to contact their legislators.

Committee members discussed the effects of Measures 5 and 50 on school funding and ways to communicate this to the public. They requested adding fiscal impacts to the unfunded mandates list to help the community members wishing to advocate.

Future Topics / Next Steps

The next meeting is scheduled to hear from regional Education Service Districts and Salem-Keizer Public Schools. Director Englesman requested outreach to local elected officials, including the Mayor, Multnomah County leaders, city councilors, and commissioners, to build partnerships on education funding.

Adjourn

Director Splitt adjourned the meeting at 12:58 pm.

Submitted by:
Rosanne Powell
Senior Board Manager / Board Secretary
Portland Public Schools